The Devil's in the Details

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by neutralcatradora

Summary

Adora makes an announcement that is totally not a big deal. At all. She definitely doesn't think it will ruin breakfast.

Bow and Glimmer disagree.

Or; Catra and Adora are getting married, but their friends aren't positive they know exactly what that means.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

The news is shared casually, like the changing of weekend plans. Like a spontaneous trip to the beach, or maybe a surprise picnic. Pleasant. Simple.

They're at breakfast when it happens.

Reconstruction is the topic at hand. Bow, Glimmer, Adora and Catra are in the midst of pinpointing the regions of Etheria that were hit the hardest over the course of the Horde's reign and calculating exactly how much humanitarian aid is needed at each location. It's been only a little over a month since Horde Prime was defeated, and Adora feels like practically every second since then has been dedicated to undoing the damage that he, along with the rest of the Horde, did.

Adora is outlining her ideas for the week when she brings it up.

"...So that's why I was thinking we should also send an extra team to Plumeria to help recover their irrigation system as quickly as possible. Their entire infrastructure is based on agriculture, so getting them enough access to water is a huge priority. Oh! Also, Catra and I are getting married, probably sometime next month. Now, about rebuilding the schoolhouse in Elberon-"

" *What?"* It comes from Bow and Glimmer simultaneously.

Adora pauses, eyes wide with confusion.

"Uh, the schoolhouse? It got hit pretty hard by a bot a few months back, and the kids have been having all their classes in the city hall, which is really not a great learning environment—"

"No, Adora, not the fucking *schoolhouse* ," Glimmer interjects, "That little thing you mentioned before that? You know, about you and Catra getting *married* ? What the fuck?"

Adora and Catra exchange confused glances.

“I-I’m sorry, am I missing something?” Adora says, wrinkling her brow. “Marriage is just promising to stay with someone you love for the rest of your lives, right? That’s what Spinerella said.”

“Netossa also said a few things about driving each other insane and working through conflict, but I don’t think that’ll be an issue for us, considering our history,” Catra added casually.

“ *No,* ” Glimmer exclaimed in a shrill voice that made Catra’s ear twitch, “I mean - yes, that’s what marriage is. Technically. But it’s not - you can’t just - Bow, *tell them.* ”

Bow gulps nervously, and Adora almost tells Glimmer she shouldn’t have put him on the spot, but there’s no question that his explanation will be clearer - and decidedly less emphatic - than hers.

“Look,” he begins, clearly going for a more gentle approach. “Marriage is like, a forever thing. Like, a literal *‘til death do us part’* kind of forever thing.”

“Yeah, we know,” Catra says slowly in a tone that practically screams *‘duh’* . “That’s kind of the point.”

Adora nods vehemently, taking Catra’s hand as if to emphasize her statement.

“I know it’s only been a month since we told each other how we feel, but we’ve known each other our whole lives! I mean, it’s not like I can imagine *not* being with her forever.” She says it so nonchalantly, as if it's the most obvious fact in the world. And really, as far as she’s concerned, it unquestionably is. “Everyone says marriage is just promising yourself to the person you love the most, and-”

“Our love *did* kind of save the universe,” Catra cuts in, “I think it’s safe to say we love each other the most.”

Adora gazes at her with the same dazed, lovestruck look she feels has been practically engraved on her face since their first kiss.

Bow and Glimmer's presence is the only thing stopping her from grabbing Catra by the shoulders and repeating that kiss, and many more, all over again.

Bow and Glimmer. Right.

"Aside from you two, obviously," Adora adds hastily, "I love you all equally. It's just, Catra and I, you know-"

"We know the difference between friendship and romance, Adora," Glimmer sighs, rubbing her temples, "No need to break it down for us."

"So?" Catra prompts, bored and clearly ready for the conversation to be over. "What's the issue?"

Glimmer takes a deep breath and closes her eyes the way she always does when she's trying to avoid becoming too…*intense*. At least, that's the word Adora likes to use. Catra uses others.

"Listen, Catra, Adora," she begins slowly, "I don't think you understand what a big deal this is. Bow and I have known each other practically our whole lives too, but *we* aren't jumping into marriage a month after our first kiss."

"I know that, but…" Adora wants to tell them that it's different, that they couldn't possibly understand the bond she shares with Catra. It's true that Bow and Glimmer have been best friends since childhood as well, but they hadn't meant everything to each other the way Catra and Adora had. They weren't the center of each other's universes, one wasn't undeniably the other's *person.* Catra has always been hers, just like she has always been Catra's. Adora doesn't doubt Bow and Glimmer love each other just as much as she and Catra do, but the concept of *forever* obviously isn't nearly as clear to them as it always has been to Adora and Catra.

Also, Bow and Glimmer's love hadn't saved the universe. Adora isn't going to let go of that one for a while.

She settles for, “I love Catra. A lot. And I want to be her wife. Forever.”

“Me too,” Catra agrees, “'Til death do us part', and all that.”

Adora is so unfathomably lovesick, she hardly even notices the uncomfortable silence that follows.

“Well,” Bow is the first to speak. “If that’s what makes you guys happy, I say you should go for it. The last few weeks have been really tough, and we could all use a celebration. Right, Glimmer?”

Glimmer doesn’t appear anywhere close to convinced.

“I still don’t think you two understand,” she mutters, “And I *don’t* think this is a good idea. But, if it’s what you really want to do…” She heaves a loud sigh and falls back in her chair. “I *guess* I’ll support you. Just don’t come crying if this ends badly.”

It’s not the kindest thing to say, and while Adora didn’t *expect* such a cynical reaction from her best friend - she didn’t expect much of a reaction at all, in fact - she’s grateful to at least have her blessing.

Bow, ever the optimist, graciously switches the subject.

“Well, now that we’ve settled that,” He begins, his tone now filled with a joviality that sounds only slightly forced, “Why don’t you tell us about how it happened? Who proposed to who?”

The confusion returns. Adora frowns and tilts her head to the side.

“Proposed?”

Bow gives her a blank stare before his expression melts into one of utter horror. Adora disregards his earlier optimism.

“Oh, no,” He stage whispers, “You don’t know what a proposal is, do you?”

"Uh…"

"You don't know what a proposal is," he repeats, sounding devastated in a way that Adora feels isn't exactly appropriate given the mundanity of the situation. "Glimmer, they don't know what a proposal is." His head falls in his hands. "You're getting married, and you don't even have a *proposal story* ."

"You're not giving us much to work with here, Arrow Boy," Catra says irately, "You wanna explain before you do that thing where you act like we're from another planet because we don't know what a cupcake is?"

"Ok, in fairness, it *was* really sad that you didn't know what cupcakes were," Glimmer pipes in. Catra ignores her.

"A proposal is when one person, well…proposes," Bow explains carefully, "Marriage, I mean. One person asks the other to marry them, and, if everything goes according to plan, the other says yes. It's an Etherian tradition, everyone does it."

Adora pauses to recall the moment they decided on the whole 'marriage' thing in the first place.

"Well, Catra is the one who suggested it. That was a proposal, right?"

Bow shakes his head, looking so distraught that Adora almost feels the need to apologize.

"The proposal is pretty much the beginning of the marriage itself. It's supposed to be a big, grand gesture, to show the other person how much you love them. It's not just a *suggestion* ."

They wait while Adora takes a moment to process the information.

"It *does* kind of seem like a missed opportunity," She says eventually with a frown and a thoughtful hand on her chin, and it's strikingly similar to her demeanor when planning a battle. "If

we’re going to do this, we should do it right, you know? Go full Etherian and all that.”

A smile plays on Catra’s lips, small and endearing. “Full Etherian? I dunno, that sounds like a lot of work.” She leans in, resting her chin on Adora’s shoulder and angling her mouth up close to her ear. “Who gives a shit about tradition? I say we just skip to the party. Netossa also mentioned something about a wedding night...”

An exaggerated gag, obviously from Glimmer.

“I know!” Adora shoots up and snaps her fingers, making Catra pull back and cross her arms with an irritated huff. “We can propose to each other. Two separate proposals. That’s pretty traditional, isn't it? I mean, if one proposal is tradition, two has to be extra Etherian, right?”

“That’s a…great idea,” Bow begins hesitantly, trying his best at enthusiasm, “But that’s not exactly how that works. Only one of you is supposed to propose, and it’s supposed to be romantic, and special, and you’re supposed to remember it for the rest of your life!” He lets out the smallest of sighs, and Adora can’t help but wonder how often he’s fantasized about a proposal involving himself and Glimmer. “Anyway, it’s not something that two people can do. That kind of defeats the point, you know?”

Adora continues unperturbed, ignoring Bow’s dispute.

“We could both come up with our own proposals,” she went on, “and surprise each other! Propose when the other is least expecting it.”

Catra’s lips curl into a smirk. “You know…A competition doesn’t sound like a bad idea. Me beating you at something seems like a great way to start married life.”

“Uh, I’m sorry,” Adora starts, sitting back down and facing Catra with a challenging glare, “ *You* beating *me* ? You wish.”

Catra rolls her eyes, her teasing grin only widening. Even after everything, there doesn't seem to be anything she loves more than getting a rise out of Adora.

"Come on, Adora. I know you're all obsessive compulsive about your plans, but when it comes down to it, I think we both know whose strategies usually end up working out and whose end up failing miserably."

Adora makes a terribly offended, indignant noise that totally *isn't* a replacement for a comeback. Because she has a comeback. Really, she does.

"My plans do *not* fail," she insists with all the conviction she can muster.

"Mmm-hm. Keep telling yourself that."

"They don't!

"All I'm saying is, my proposal is gonna be way better and really embarrassing for you. It's okay, I'll be sure to include lots of good food to distract you from the sting of defeat."

Adora vaguely registers Glimmer groaning, and Bow muttering something about how completely unromantic and far too chaotic their newfound competition was, but she's too focused on her infuriating soon-to-be wife to give it much thought.

Adora huffs and leans in close to Catra's face in what she intends to be a show of confidence and intimidation, but Catra's lips are *right there* and unfairly distracting and really, it would be completely unreasonable for her *not* to kiss them.

"You are *so* on," she whispers before closing the distance. Catra tangles a hand in her hair, and Adora knows, has always known, she wants this forever.

They never cared much about tradition, anyway.

End Notes

Cue Glimmer groaning and begging to have just one meal that doesn't end with a catradora makeout session

I'm kind of nervous about publishing this since it's been years since I've really written anything and this is my first She Ra fic!! So I would sincerely love and appreciate any comments <3 Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!